

# TourGPT

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## **Abstract**

A key problem many people run into when planning a trip is deciphering whether or not a place is a “tourist trap” or not. Our solution is creating “Tour GPT”, an AI chatbot that shows users a list of tours in a specific city with sentiment analysis and pricing, ranked from best to worst. We run through our main implementation approach, the deciding factors of what would be considered as a “tourist trap”, such as price and reviews, and the implications of our chatbot.

## **Introduction**

Travelling to new places can be a fun but stressful experience. One big issue I usually run into when finding new places to visit is not knowing if a location is a “tourist trap” or not. This is why we decided to make the TGPT (Tour GPT). This will take in a destination you’re interested in, such as a city, and the dates you’ll be in the area for. It will then generate a list of 5 of the top tours it was able to find from the Viator API, the sentiment score, price of the tour, and a link to the tour site. Our objective is to accurately display the safest, “best value” tours in a specific city for users to be able to select from and provide a practical tool for everyday trip planning.

## **Related Work**

### **Layla AI [1]**

Layla AI is a chatbot that allows users to plan trips. Users are prompted to give a place, who they are travelling with, timeframe, area you are travelling from, and budget. The output ends up as a fully planned itinerary with hotels and locations catered to the user’s inputs. However, it lacks depth and mostly stays in ‘tourist traps’ and does not select the cheapest flights or hotels.

The main difference between our TourGPT and Layla is that our chatbot shows users the best value tour from all tours provided on Viator for a specific date and destination, deciding the value based on user reviews and price. In contrast, Layla fully plans trips for users and picks destinations for them and bases them on “deals” exclusive to Layla, with the added caveat of a subscription.

### **mindtrip [2]**

Mindtrip is very similar to Layla. It is a tool that allows users to plan an itinerary based on destination and preferences, with the added ability to view popular itineraries from other users. However, unlike Layla, it does not take into account flights or hotels, and does not list the prices for the activities that it selects. Unlike mindtrip, TourGPT provides a direct link to the tours that

it selects, and will not have the ability to plan a full itinerary. TourGPT is only meant to give users a list of the top tours it has selected for a destination, not necessarily plan an entire trip.

### **EasyTripAI [3]**

EasyTripAI allows users to input a destination and show what it calls a crowd forecast, scam detector, and cost reality check. The crowd forecast feature allows users to predict tourist density for the exact dates inputted by the user. The scam detector feature allows users to see a real-time “risk map” of the place they would like to visit. The cost reality check feature allows users to calculate the full estimated cost of a trip taking into account hidden taxes, tips, and current inflation rates.

Unlike TourGPT, EasyTripAI allows users to view these metrics but not specific tours. TourGPT’s main goal is to give users a tour that is within a specified destination and date range and scores highly with our “value score” metric, taking into account user review sentiment and tour pricing.

### **Airial [4]**

Airial is a related service that allows users to build itineraries for a specific trip. It is very similar to EasyTripAI, in the sense that it does not seem to be as focused on being a chatbot, but rather a tool for recommending destinations and planning vacations. Additionally, unlike what we are doing with TourGPT, it doesn’t seem to take into account the pricing of a place of interest or appear to select the “best value” option for users.

### **Trip Planner AI [5]**

This website allows users to input the duration of a trip, destination, and motivation for the trip, and outputs an itinerary for the chosen destination. A link is then provided under each result to be able to research and book tours. Unlike the TourGPT that we have built, the AI Trip Planner does not select the best tour results for a specific destination. Additionally, it only links to one specific website (Get Your Guide).

### **Methodology**

Our early idea was to use Viator API to find information on tours and create a schedule based on the user's interests and desires. Early into development with the API it became clear that obtaining a schedule that’s available by a model wouldn’t be feasible due to the strange returned values from Viator API. We are still able to obtain tour information for tours running between specific dates in a location.

Our input comes in the form of text. We use a basic text understanding chatbot to turn user input into a usable format for finding tours through a Viator API tool. From there we take each tour and find reviews for the tour company through Google Maps. We then asynchronously evaluate

each review using a sentiment analysis model. We then pass the results into a new chatbot and ask it to evaluate the tour based on the information given. This produces a recommendation system that leverages AI to evaluate different tours based on how likely they are to be a tourist trap. We look at prices and review sentiment scores primarily for our results. The results are then sent to frontend UI. In repeat cases, information is pulled from a database to save token costs.

## **Results**

Our project has resulted in a tool that evaluates tours in a given area to determine whether they are tourist traps. It automatically processes reviews, assigns a score to each tour, and informs the user which tours are recommended and which are not. The system is fairly token-efficient due to its use of a database, though there is still room for improvement in refining the prompting and the specific factors the model considers when scoring each tour.

## **Discussion**

Our project was fairly successful for the time we had to work on it. There's definitely more work that can be done and should be done if we ever want this to be a real useful tool. The UI for our tool appears to be text based, but does require a certain input format. My first change would be to make this appear fully chatbot like or to remove the chatbot like UI for a more favorable UI with separate input boxes.

I'd also like to revisit our idea for the tours to be preferenced, meaning the user will have their interests and the model will take those into account before scoring each tour. Ideally it would filter out tours that would likely not interest the user, making this tool more of a tour finder.

There are also many more aspects for tours that we should take into consideration for evaluation. We prioritize the reviews and costs currently. Cross referencing results across different models and review applications may be helpful. For example we could also pull reviews from Yelp for this purpose instead of only Google Maps.

## **Conclusion**

Our final product delivers a functional tool that evaluates tours to determine whether they are likely tourist traps. Although we had to pivot from our original vision, the end result reflects a strong and practical proof of concept. While the tool currently incorporates less user input than we initially intended, it effectively demonstrates the potential and real-world application of this idea. Throughout development, we encountered a range of challenges, including limitations with sentiment analysis tools, inconsistencies across models, API token constraints, and difficulties working with the Viator API. These obstacles highlighted that such technologies are often more complex and less accessible than expected. Despite this, we adapted to these challenges and successfully delivered a working system that lays the groundwork for future improvements.

### **References**

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